

From comments to controlled rule updates

A secure, explainable workflow that reviews state fee-schedule comments, compares them with current rules, and routes every case to the right outcome.

THE BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Thousands of fee-schedule rows can include free-text analyst comments. Manual review is slow, varies by reviewer, and is difficult to scale.

9

workflow stages

3

decision outcomes

85%

confidence gate

ONE-LINE TAKEAWAY

The solution automates the repeatable work, applies a fixed safety threshold, and keeps people in control whenever the evidence is unclear.

Why the approach evolved

We began with transparent rule patterns, learned where language variation created risk, and moved to contextual interpretation with the same business controls.

1 | Structured pattern approach

Why it was a sensible starting point

Fast, deterministic, traceable, and no per-comment AI dependency.

How it worked

A library of about 25 patterns identified rates, dates, age limits, authorization, codes, service limits, methodology terms, and change language.



2 | Context-aware approach

What the business needed next

Interpret different writing styles, understand the whole comment, and compare its meaning with the current rule.

Why Azure OpenAI

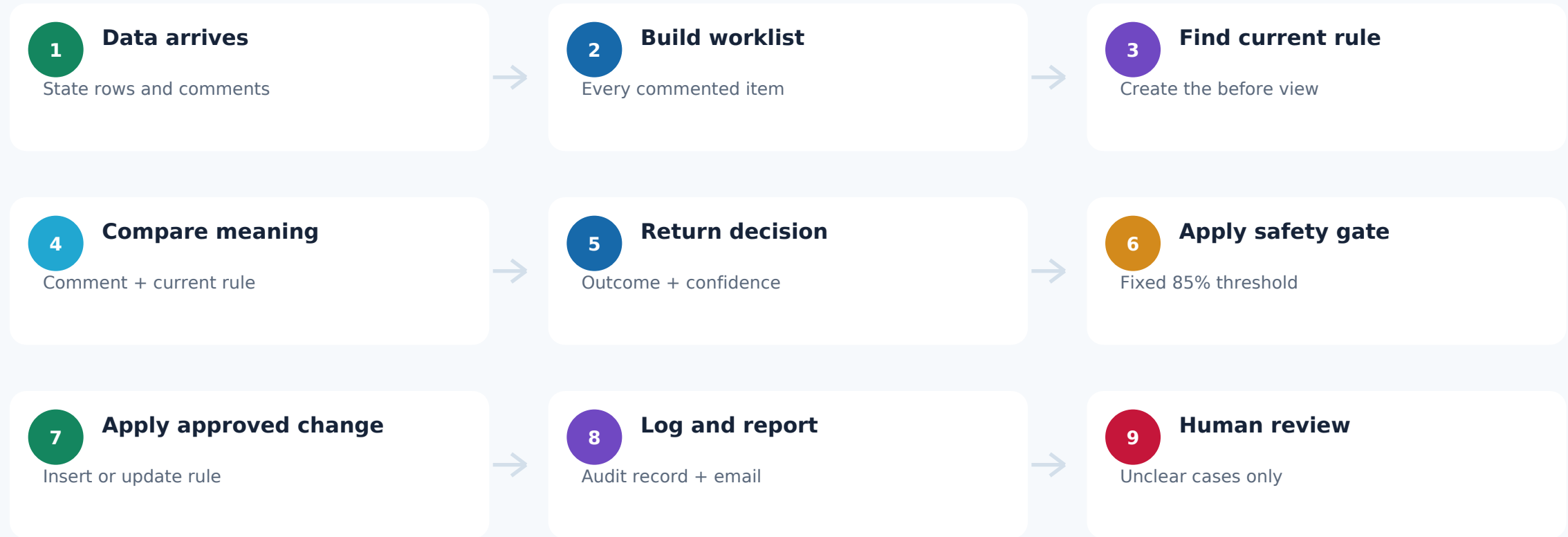
It provides secure enterprise language interpretation inside the company cloud while returning a controlled, structured decision.

KEY LEARNING

Pattern matching can identify known phrases; the operational need is to understand intent across new wording without continually adding another rule.

The complete workflow - start to finish

Only one stage interprets language. The surrounding stages remain deterministic data processing, business rules, logging, and human review.



The workflow processes a full state worklist automatically; only cases that fail the confidence gate leave the automated path.

1-4 | Prepare the evidence and ask the right question

1

Data comes in

The state fee-schedule rows and analyst comments already stored in SQL Server become the source. The existing system of record does not change.

2

Build the worklist

A database query groups every row with a comment by code and rule area. The business can see the full scope before any language analysis begins.

3

Reconstruct the current rule

The workflow converts the currently configured rule into a readable before-view for the same code.

4

Compare side by side

The analyst comment and the current-rule view are submitted together. The task is narrowly defined: determine whether they agree and what must change.

BUSINESS CONTROL

Scope and current-state evidence are established before interpretation starts.

5-6 | Convert interpretation into a controlled decision

The response is returned in a predictable structure: business outcome, fields to change, confidence score, and plain-English explanation.

ALIGNED

Current comment and configured rule agree. No change.

MISALIGNED

The response identifies the exact field, value, and rule change required.

NOT CLEAR

The case is flagged; the workflow does not guess.

FIXED SAFETY RULE

85%

minimum confidence for an automatic change

PASS

At or above 85%:
approved path

REVIEW

Below 85%:
human path

7-9 | Apply, record, report, and escalate

Every result is accounted for - whether nothing changed, an approved update was applied, or a person must review the case.



APPLY

Only approved misalignments move forward. The workflow inserts a new rule or updates the existing rule exactly as specified.



LOG + REPORT

Each outcome is recorded with its explanation and confidence. A summary email provides run-level visibility.



HUMAN REVIEW

Low-confidence items enter the normal review process. They are a focused subset, not the full state workload.

AUDITABILITY BY DESIGN

The business can trace the source comment, the current rule, the decision, the confidence, the explanation, and the final disposition for every item.

Faster processing without giving up oversight

The operating model combines language understanding with fixed business controls, explicit routing, and full visibility.

SPEED

State-level review moves from hours or days toward minutes.

CONSISTENCY

The same decision structure and safety rule are used for every item.

SCALE

New wording can be interpreted without continually extending a phrase library.

CONTROL

Nothing below the confidence threshold is changed automatically.

TRANSPARENCY

Each decision includes a plain-English explanation and is logged.

FOCUS

Reviewers spend time on genuinely unclear cases instead of every row.

BUSINESS OUTCOME

Automate the repeatable decisions, preserve human judgment for uncertainty, and maintain a complete audit trail from source to outcome.